

Tips & Tricks

SECRETS THAT KEEP YOU AHEAD IN THE RACE

TIPS

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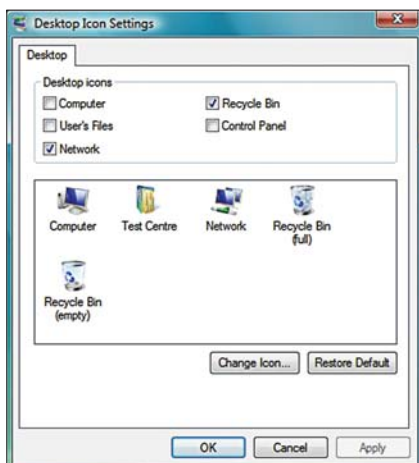
30 MINUTES EXPERT

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WINDOWS VISTA

Adding Desktop Icons And Customising Them

The only icons on the desktop you will find after a clean install of Vista is that of the Recycle Bin. We love our desktops, and it's one of the quickest ways to access programs. To get icons of the other necessary programs in Vista like the Computer and Network, right-click on the desktop and select Personalize. Click on Change desktop icons in the left pane. Check the boxes for the icons that you require on the desktop. Click OK.



Necessary desktop icons can be set to be displayed on the desktop

The same window also allows you to set custom icons for each item. Click on the icon that needs to be changed and click the Change Icon button. Select the icon of your choice and click OK.

Disabling Folders And Links In The Start Menu

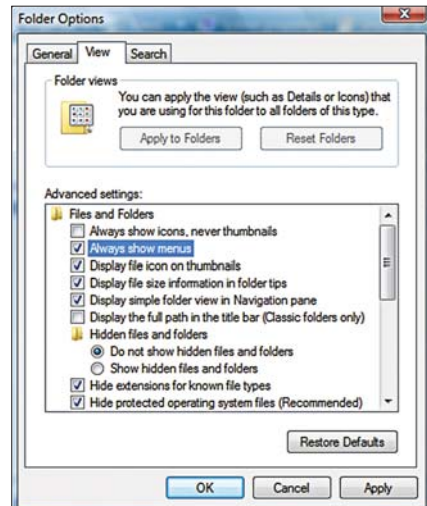
The Vista Start Menu has links to almost everything: Music, Games, Pictures, Documents, etc. You may not need all of these, or you may need to add some more shortcuts. To remove these links, right-click on the taskbar and click on Properties. Click on the Start Menu tab. Here you can choose to set the Start Menu to look like older Windows versions, you can choose to select the Classic Start menu by clicking the radio box. To remove the unnecessary items, click on Customize next to Start menu. To disable the links, check the radio box—Don't display this item for the items you want removed. Click OK when done.

Changing Power Button Characteristics

Vista has this useful option of allowing the user to choose the function that the Power button on your computer performs. Go to Start > Control Panel and (if you're using the Classic View) double-click on Power Options > Choose what the power button does. To do this from the standard Control Panel view, go to System and Maintenance > Power Options > Choose what the power button does. Once you've got here, you will find that the options are disabled by default, so click on Change settings that are currently unavailable. Click on the dropdown for the Power button settings. Choose from Sleep, Hibernate and Shut down. Click Save Changes when you're done.

Accessing The File Menu

One of the characteristics of Vista is that there might not be any File menu in some of the applications such as Windows Explorer for example. At any time to access this menu, press [Alt]. To permanently enable the menus, open Windows Explorer. Go to Organize > Folder and Search Options. Click on the View tab and check the box for Always show menus. Click OK.



Pressing Alt shows the File menu which isn't displayed on Vista by default

Search The Internet Quickly

Microsoft has implemented the search bar within the Start Menu in Windows Vista. Its main purpose is to access files and programs quickly but it can be used to search the Internet as well. Click on the Start button or press the Windows key on your keyboard. Enter the keywords in the search field. Click on Search the Internet to use the default search engine (Live Search). In Windows Explorer, the search field normally searches the local drive. Pressing [Shift] + [Enter] after entering the keyword will open up a new browser window with results of the search in the default search engine.

Adding New Search Engines To The List

You just learnt how to use the Start Menu to search the Net. You can also change the default search engine Vista uses. To do this, start Internet Explorer. Click on the dropdown in the Search field and click Find More Providers. A page should load with a list of some search engines. Click on the search engine you want to use. A confirmation window will pop up. Click Add Provider. If you want to make it your default search engine, check the "Make this my default search provider" box. Click OK. Now all Internet searches done by you